OPENER MAT · KEEP IT ON YOUR TABLE

When, Where, How

Beyond the gate, a narrow path appeared.

Opener, comma, then the rest of the sentence.

When?

TIME OPENER · WRITE T

- At dawn,
- At midnight,
- After school,
- Early that morning,
- Later that night,
- As the sun set,
- Before long,
- After a while,
- Moments later,
- Seconds later,
- Just then,
- At that moment,
- Straight away,
- Without warning,
- For a long moment,
- Within seconds,
- At last,
- All afternoon,

Where?

PLACE OPENER · WRITE P

- Behind the shed,
- Beyond the gate,
- Inside the cave,
- Above her head,
- Beneath the floorboards,
- At the top of the stairs,
- Along the path,
- Across the river,
- Deep in the forest,
- In the distance,
- Somewhere ahead,
- All around her,
- Through the window,
- Next to the door,
- Far below,
- On every side,
- At the end of the hall,
- Under the bridge,

How?

MANNER OPENER · WRITE M

- Slowly,
- Carefully,
- Quietly,
- Gently,
- Bravely,
- Eagerly,
- Without a sound,
- On tiptoe,
- Step by step,
- In a whisper,
- With a gasp,
- With a grin,
- As fast as she could,
- Holding her breath,
- Heart pounding,
- With trembling fingers,
- Squinting,
- Rubbing her eyes,

Link back

POINTS BACK

- Beyond it,
- Behind her,
- Inside,
- At the top,
- Next to it,
- Above them,
- On the other side,
- Even closer,
- Moments later,
- Seconds later,
- Before long,
- After that,

Mix it up. Not every sentence needs an opener. Keep one sentence plain.

Link it back. *Beyond it, Moments later, Behind her,* point back to the sentence before.

Watch out. *Then,* and *Suddenly,* once at most.

CHOOSE ONE PARAGRAPH · REBUILD IT IN YOUR BOOK

Six flat paragraphs

1. Write the letter and title.
2. Rewrite it with new openers.
3. Underline each opener. Write T, P or M above it.
4. Circle the comma.

A The Door in the Fence

Keeps starting: **I**

1. **I** found a tiny wooden door in the back fence.
2. **I** pushed it open.
3. **I** saw a garden full of glowing flowers.
4. **I** walked along a winding path.
5. **I** found a stone fountain shaped like a fish.

B The Museum at Night

Keeps starting: **We**

1. **We** were having a class sleepover at the museum.
2. **We** crept past the giant whale skeleton.
3. **We** noticed a door that was open a crack.
4. **We** peered inside.
5. **We** saw shelves of glittering crystals.

C The Glowing Cave

Keeps starting: **Zara**

1. **Zara** climbed down the rocks at the beach.
2. **Zara** found a cave behind a curtain of seaweed.
3. **Zara** switched on her torch.
4. **Zara** saw the walls sparkle blue and green.
5. **Zara** heard the sea echoing behind her.

D The Old Treehouse

Keeps starting: **Then**

1. Ruby climbed the rickety ladder to the old treehouse.
2. **Then** she pushed open the trapdoor.
3. **Then** she saw a room full of dusty maps.
4. **Then** she found a brass telescope by the window.
5. **Then** she spotted an island she had never seen before.

E The Floating Market

Keeps starting: **The**

1. **The** little boat drifted into a busy floating market.
2. **The** stalls were piled high with mangoes and spices.
3. **The** air smelt of sweet coconut.
4. **The** sellers called out to Priya.
5. **The** boat stopped beside a stall of paper lanterns.

F The Forgotten Station

Keeps starting: **She**

1. Isla followed the old railway line into the bush.
2. **She** found a tiny station covered in vines.
3. **She** brushed the dust off a sign.
4. **She** read the faded name: Willow Creek.
5. **She** heard a whistle in the distance.

ENTRY FLOOR · PICK'N'MIX

Choose an opener

1. Choose one opener for at least three sentences.
2. Use When, Where and How at least once.
3. Write the new sentences in your book.

+ Make one opener your own: change a word.

A The Door in the Fence

Keeps starting: I

1 **I** found a tiny wooden door in the back fence.
- T On Saturday morning,
- P Behind the old shed,
- M By pure luck,

2 **I** pushed it open.
- T After a moment,
- P Through a tangle of ivy,
- M Very slowly,

3 **I** saw a garden full of glowing flowers.
- T At once,
- P Beyond the door,
- M Blinking in surprise,

4 **I** walked along a winding path.
- T Moments later,
- P Between the flowers,
- M On tiptoe,

5 **I** found a stone fountain shaped like a fish.
- T Before long,
- P In the middle of the garden,
- M With a gasp,

B The Museum at Night

Keeps starting: We

1 **We** were having a class sleepover at the museum.
- T Last Friday night,
- P In the great hall of the museum,
- M In our pyjamas,

2 **We** crept past the giant whale skeleton.
- T After lights out,
- P Along the dark corridor,
- M Without a sound,

3 **We** noticed a door that was open a crack.
- T Just then,
- P At the end of the hall,
- M With wide eyes,

4 **We** peered inside.
- T For a long moment,
- P Through the gap,
- M Holding our breath,

5 **We** saw shelves of glittering crystals.
- T Seconds later,
- P On every wall,
- M Dazzled,

ENTRY FLOOR · PICK'N'MIX

Choose an opener

1. Choose one opener for at least three sentences.
2. Use When, Where and How at least once.
3. Write the new sentences in your book.

+ Make one opener your own: change a word.

C The Glowing Cave

Keeps starting: **Zara**

1. **Zara** climbed down the rocks at the beach.
   - T Early that morning,
   - P At the far end of the beach,
   - M Carefully,
2. **Zara** found a cave behind a curtain of seaweed.
   - T Before long,
   - P Behind a curtain of seaweed,
   - M Pushing the seaweed aside,
3. **Zara** switched on her torch.
   - T Straight away,
   - P Inside the cave,
   - M With trembling fingers,
4. **Zara** saw the walls sparkle blue and green.
   - T At once,
   - P All around her,
   - M Slowly,
5. **Zara** heard the sea echoing behind her.
   - T Moments later,
   - P Behind her,
   - M Faintly,

D The Old Treehouse

Keeps starting: **Then**

1. Ruby climbed the rickety ladder to the old treehouse.
   - T After school,
   - P At the bottom of the garden,
   - M Rung by rung,
2. **Then** she pushed open the trapdoor.
   - T A minute later,
   - P At the top of the ladder,
   - M With one big shove,
3. **Then** she saw a room full of dusty maps.
   - T At once,
   - P Inside,
   - M Blinking in the gloom,
4. **Then** she found a brass telescope by the window.
   - T After a while,
   - P By the window,
   - M Brushing away cobwebs,
5. **Then** she spotted an island she had never seen before.
   - T Within seconds,
   - P Far out at sea,
   - M Squinting through the lens,

ENTRY FLOOR · PICK'N'MIX

Choose an opener

1. Choose one opener for at least three sentences.
2. Use When, Where and How at least once.
3. Write the new sentences in your book.

+ Make one opener your own: change a word.

E The Floating Market

Keeps starting: **The**

1 **The** little boat drifted into a busy floating market.
- T As the sun rose,
- P Around a bend in the river,
- M Gently,

2 **The** stalls were piled high with mangoes and spices.
- T Even this early,
- P On every side,
- M In tottering towers,

3 **The** air smelt of sweet coconut.
- T All morning,
- P Everywhere Priya turned,
- M Warm and sticky,

4 **The** sellers called out to Priya.
- T Every few seconds,
- P From their wooden boats,
- M Cheerfully,

5 **The** boat stopped beside a stall of paper lanterns.
- T At last,
- P Beside a stall of paper lanterns,
- M With a gentle bump,

F The Forgotten Station

Keeps starting: **She**

1 Isla followed the old railway line into the bush.
- T After lunch,
- P Past the edge of town,
- M Step by step,

2 **She** found a tiny station covered in vines.
- T After an hour,
- P In a small clearing,
- M Pushing through the ferns,

3 **She** brushed the dust off a sign.
- T Straight away,
- P On the platform,
- M With her sleeve,

4 **She** read the faded name: Willow Creek.
- T At last,
- P Beneath the dust,
- M Squinting,

5 **She** heard a whistle in the distance.
- T Just then,
- P Somewhere down the line,
- M Faintly,